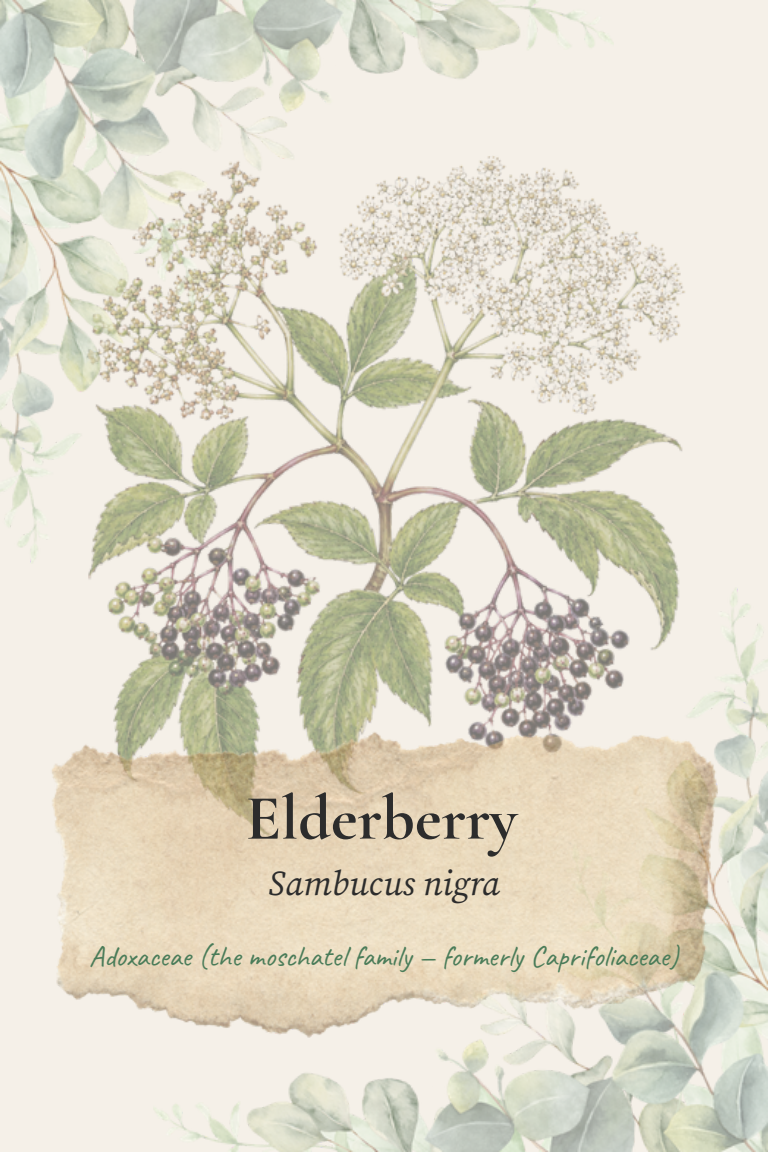




Elderberry

Sambucus nigra

Adoxaceae (the moschatel family – formerly Caprifoliaceae)



ELDERBERRY

Sambucus nigra

Properties

- Supports the immune system.
- Cooling + drying —
- Brings down fevers and tightens loose tissue (runny noses, watery coughs).

Preparation

Syrup — simmer ½ cup dried berries in 4 cups water until reduced to 1 cup (30-45 min). Cool. Add ½ cup raw honey. Refrigerate; opens Wk 9.

Tea — simmer dried berries 15 min (cooked only).

Identify by

- Compound UMBEL — many tiny stems radiating from one center, each with a single berry.
- Compound leaves — pinnate, 5-7 leaflets paired along a central rib.
- Berries deep purple-black when ripe; stems reddish-purple.

Caution

Raw berries, stems, and leaves are TOXIC (cyanogenic glycosides). Only cooked ripe BLACK berries are safe. Confirm species: *Sambucus nigra* (NOT *S. racemosa*, red elder).

